EUROPEAN MASTERS ATHLETICS

E.M.A. OFF-ROAD RUNNING CIRCUIT 2026

1. Overview

European Masters Athletics (EMA) proudly presents the **first official edition of the EMA Off-Road Running Circuit**, a continental series of races dedicated to Masters athletes, featuring **mountain, vertical, and trail running events**.

Objectives

The EMA Off-Road Running Circuit aims to:

- Provide optimal conditions for athletes to achieve outstanding performances.
- Increase competition opportunities in a stimulating and diverse environment.
- Foster greater interaction and cultural exchange among athletes.
- Offer a broad range of participation options throughout the season.
- Promote diversity and inclusion among participants.

EMA's organizational focus is on ensuring **well-structured and efficiently managed events**, offering the best possible conditions for athletes to perform and enjoy their experience.

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2. Participation

Participation in the **EMA Off-Road Running Circuit** is open to all athletes who meet the **Masters Off-Road running criteria**, specifically:

- **Aged 35–79 years**, unless otherwise restricted by local rules for long-distance events.
- **Licensed by their National Federation**, in accordance with **World Masters Athletics (WMA) rules**.

The EMA Off-Road Running Circuit is **not a championship**; therefore:

- Athletes **do not officially represent their countries**, and
- The **use of national uniforms is optional**.

Participation is also open to **non-European athletes**, who are eligible for both **individual event prizes** and **final circuit awards**.

2.1 Liability and Insurance

- Participation is entirely at the athlete's own risk.
- The **Organizer** shall not be held liable for any damage or injury sustained by a participant, except where such damage results directly from the Organizer's intentional actions.
- This waiver includes, but is not limited to, incidents involving accidents or death.
- If the Organizer's insurance covers a claim, its liability shall be limited to the insurer's payment amount.
- Participants are advised to take out **personal insurance** covering potential risks such as accidents, illness, or death during the event.

By registering, each participant:

- Declares being in good physical and mental condition;
- Confirms having trained adequately for the event; and
- Is encouraged to undergo a **medical fitness examination** prior to participation.

Participants are also responsible for any damage they cause to third parties, including other athletes, volunteers, or spectators.

2.2 Data Protection

By registering, athletes authorize the Organizer and European Masters Athletics to use their personal data (name, email, date of birth) for:

- Stage and final rankings; and
- Promotional purposes related to the EMA League.

All data will be processed in accordance with applicable **data protection laws**.

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3. Rankings

3.1 Event Rankings

Each **Local Organizing Committee (LOC)** may host one or more events (uphill, vertical, mountain run up & down, trail, etc.).
Event prizes and category awards will be given according to **local regulations**. Each event will be featured in a **dedicated section** on the **EMA website**.

LOCs may, at their discretion, allow athletes **under 35 or over 80** to compete and be awarded locally.
However, for the **EMA Circuit's final rankings**, only **Masters athletes aged 35–79** will be considered.

3.2 Final Circuit Rankings

To qualify for the **final EMA rankings**, an athlete must:

- Participate in **at least two events**, held in **different locations**.

Scoring System:

- The **winner** of each event (overall and age category) receives **1 point**.
- The **second** receives **2 points**, the **third** receives **3 points**, and so on.
- EMA will consider **each athlete's two best performances** from different events when calculating the final standings.
- Each athlete can participate to more than one event in the same stage (example uphill and long distance), if offered by the Organiser. But only the best performance will be considered for the general ranking.

Ranking Categories:

- **Overall Men and Women (Top 3)**
- **Age Categories** (M/W 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75)

Tie-break Rules:
In the event of a tie:

1. The athlete with the **higher finishing position** in head-to-head events will be ranked higher.
2. If still tied, the athlete with **more total races completed** in the Circuit will be ranked higher.

3.3 Special Awards

- A **Fidelity Award** (special souvenir or recognition) will be presented to all athletes who participate in **at least three events**, regardless of final ranking.

The **official award ceremony** will take place during the **2027 EMA Off-Road Running Championship**. Athletes not present will be contacted to arrange prize delivery.

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4. Event Organization

Each **Local Organizing Committee (LOC)** shall:

- Follow EMA's Off-Road Running Circuit guidelines and safety standards.
- Ensure appropriate **course marking**, **medical assistance**, and **environmental responsibility**.
- Provide race results in EMA's **approved format** within **72 hours** after the event.
- Display the **official EMA flag** and logos visibly at the event site.

EMA will:

- Promote each event via its **website, social media, and newsletters**.
- Manage the **Circuit's cumulative rankings and awards**.
- Provide **guidance** to LOCs to maintain consistent quality and standards.

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5. Calendar

The **EMA Off-Road Running Circuit 2026** will include a series of mountain and trail events scheduled throughout the season.
The provisional calendar will be published and regularly updated on the **EMA website**.

Provisional 2026 Calendar (more events may be added):

- May, 10 – Lloretrail – Lloret del Mar (ESP)
- May, 24 – Montée du Ventoux – Hameau des Baux (FRA)
- June, 21 – Aviano-Piancavallo 10 miles – Aviano (ITA)
- July, 10-11 – Stana de Vale Trail Race – Stana de Vale (ROM)

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6. Final Provisions

Each event's local regulations shall apply, provided they do not conflict with the present **EMA Off-Road Running Circuit Regulations** or **WMA Technical Rules**.
In any case of discrepancy, **EMA/WM/WMRA's regulations** shall prevail.